Field Notes Template

Community Engagement Project

Your Name: _____

Date: _____ **Time:** _____

Location/Site: _____

Type of Site/Activity: _____

Length of Observation: _____

> **Important:** Be respectful of people's privacy. Ask permission before recording someone, conducting a formal interview, or taking identifiable photographs.

1. Before You Begin: First Impressions

Before exploring the site in detail, take a moment to look around. What immediately catches your attention? What did you expect to see before arriving? Is anything different from what you expected?

First-impression Notes:

2. Observe: What Do You See and Hear?

Record specific details rather than general impressions. Consider:

- Physical setting, decorations, signs, objects, food, clothing, music, or other cultural elements
- Languages you see or hear
- People present and what they are doing
- Interactions among people
- Activities or practices taking place
- How East Asian culture is presented or represented
- Anything surprising, interesting, or unfamiliar

Observation Notes:

3. Interact: What Happened?

If you interact with community members, briefly document the interaction. Who did you interact with? What did you talk about or do? What did you learn from this interaction?

Interaction Notes:

4. Reflect: What Does It Mean?

Now move from observation to interpretation. What does your experience tell you about East Asian cultural presence in the local community? What connections can you make to concepts, readings, films, or discussions from our course? Did anything challenge or change your previous assumptions about East Asian culture?

Reflection Notes:

5. Ask: What Do You Want to Know More About?

Write 2–3 questions that emerged from your observation. These questions can help guide the next Research stage of your Community Engagement Project.

Question 1: _____

Question 2: _____

Question 3: _____